

The Ladder of Prayer

"And Jacob dreamed, and behold! A ladder stood on the earth, and the top of it reached heavenward (Genesis 28:12)

Zohar: Jacob's ladder is a metaphor for prayer.

Through prayer, rung by rung we are connecting the finite, material world with the Infinite. The base may be rooted on the earth, the finite, but the highest step reaches the Heavens, the Infinite.

SITTING 

STANDING 

NO TALKING 

ברכת השחר Birchat Hashachar Morning Blessings

Theme:
Blessings
associated with
the act of waking,
arising, and going
about our daily
affairs.

Pages 5 - 9

Page 5: Netilat Yadayim:
One should ritually wash one's
hands upon arising, first on the
right hand, then on the left hand,
a total of three times on each
hand. Then say the blessing
"Al Netilat Yadayim"

פסוקי דזמרה Pesukei Dezimrah Verses of Praise

Theme:
We praise and
thank G-d's
revelation in
nature and history,
and focus on how
His glory can be
seen in Creation.

Pages 30-38

Most Important:

Baruch Sheamar:
Page 30

Ashrei:
Pages 31, 32

Yishtabach:
Page 38

ברכת שמע ושמע Birchat Shema Ushema Shema & its Blessings

Theme:
Kabbalat Ol
Malchut
Shamayim-
accepting G-d's
absolute
sovereignty and
declaring G-d's
unity.

Pages 39-45

Most Important:

The three
paragraphs
of Shema:

Pages 42, 43, 44

עמידה The Amidah

Theme:
We are now ready
to come "face to
face" with G-d,
and ask for our
personal needs.

Weekday Amidah:
Pages 45-54

The weekday Amidah is
divided into three sections:
First 3 blessings=Praise
Middle 13 blessings=Requests
Last three blessings=Thanks

Shabbat Amidah:
Pages 211-217

*Begin and end Amidah by taking
3 steps back, then 3 steps forward
Three steps back: Left, Right, Left, Together
Three steps forward: Right, Left, Right, Together